

Avast Antivirus 5.0

Avast Antivirus' latest version has improvements in virus detection techniques

More patching

Microsoft to release a patch to plug security holes in its flag ship browser – Internet Explorer

INVADERS FROM OUTSIDE

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Let's face it. Viruses, worms, roots and its other many forms will always be a problem for PCs and all computing devices. While most of this so called malicious code exploits holes in the operating system, we as humans are partly to blame. All antivirus and security suites do is offer that additional layer of prevention. If we were wise enough to avoid all the obvious threats by not clicking on that very oddly named .exe file or executing that mail attachment, we wouldn't need a security suite, would we?

As it turns out, very few of us avoid all of these mails and files, and sometimes because of the security bugs in the software and operating systems we use, they do get infected. And when they do, we have no one to save us! Security suites simply ensure that these viruses and worms don't intrude into your system.

With the kind of viruses and worms being designed to hit every security suite out there, once a worm or virus is in, hope is lost. There starts the long and painful journey to fix. Most worms will disable access to sites to ensure you can't find a fix or update to disable the paralysed suite. Therefore, one of the key things companies have had to do is to update the virus definition and use more intensive techniques to detect such threats and disable them first.

In this feature, we look at some of the most popular security suites, many of which are available in India. We are also aware that people have their favourites like with any other product category — only in this case, there are no clear ones.

K7 TotalSecurity 10

K7 Computing is one of the lesser known players in the security solution market. Their product called K7 TotalSecurity is a complete security suite for desktop users.



The threats may have reduced but for how long? We review some of the suites out there and see if their claims hold any truth...

When you start the installation, K7 TotalSecurity does a preliminary scan to ensure there are no threats pre-existing on the system. After the installation, and with the suite registered, updates are downloaded and installed. There is little to go wrong here.

K7 TotalSecurity is a thorough security suite, but the interface isn't enticing. K7 has gone with a very traditional and simplistic approach but the quality and design of the icons and layout could definitely be improved.

The interface looks as if there are only a limited number of features and also a limited amount of settings available for each of those features. When you get into each of the settings and try to modify the parameters, you notice the complex menus and terminology.

The firewall allows blocking of

network traffic, but you can manage an allow list for critical applications such as your browser and different components of the security suite as well. There is also support to protect popular instant messengers such as AOL, MSN and Yahoo messengers. It also integrates with Outlook to take care of any spam.

Separate logs are maintained for events related to each of the components that make up the security suite.

Memory consumption crossed over 120MB while scanning the system for viruses. With our system running on 1 GB of memory, it showed noticeable slowdown. All in all, a decent solution but one that people might ignore just because of the appearance.

**Price: Rs. 600 , (single user – 1 year)
Rs. 1,500 (3 users – 1 year)**